

UNIVERSITY OF THE INCARNATE WORD

HSI: Battle of the Brains 2026



Outline of Proposed Solution: NARAH

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Problem Statement

Customers are relying on AI assistants for online shopping, reducing company website traffic and posing potential misinformation of the product, thus creating trust and accuracy risk for the customers.

Proposed Solution

NARAH, a subscription based website designed for companies and for use by potential customers, that provides only information from official sites and official retailer sites, information that is updated alongside the official website of each company, so that customers can make decisions only based on reliable information.

Helping companies by giving them easy access to their customized market statistics at any time, and they receive monthly summaries where they can see their growth through charts or their areas of opportunity to improve, measure success with traffic and conversions.

Expected Impact

We expect to turn AI shopping from a “blind spot” into a channel where companies can measure, adjust, and grow. First of all, there will be more visibility in AI answers. We will measure how often a brand appears when shoppers ask AI for recommendations. By adjusting the pages AI relies on, we expect to increase the inclusion rate by 5 percentage points within the first 90 days.

Another target is 95% or more of product facts stated correctly across the AI assistants we will be actively tracking. We expect solid revenue from the start as AI continues to grow and customers will most likely not stop using AI assistants. Lastly, we expect to increase customer trust. Fewer customers will buy based on wrong information, which means that there will be fewer returns and support tickets that are tied to AI errors. We will track both of these things before and after the pilot to prove it. Ultimately, we aim to increase company exposure, make companies aware of unreliable information being used by AI, and increase customer trust.

Risks

Speed: Because it's going to have a lot of information, it might take a little time to give the correct recommendation since it has to look through all the official company sites.

Wrong product availability: It could be that at the moment you ask them for a computer, our option gives you the option of a product, but on the page they might not have it.

Privacy: Privacy can be mentioned as a risk, but we are not going to use any information that isn't public from the companies. We are only going to use the companies' official websites, which means we will only use official sites that we can base our website on to give the best recommendation for a product.

Implementation Roadmap

Short Term- Website development, official data integration, and the creation of an analytics dashboard.

Medium Term- Website launch, monthly company reports, subscription rollout, performance tracking.

Long Term-Company Expansion (from source companies to authorized retailers), advanced analytics, and continuous platform improvement.

Brand History

NARAH was founded by a team of five students at the University of the Incarnate Word, bringing together finance, international business, and data analytics. The idea came from a shift in consumers' shopping habits. More people now ask an AI assistant what to buy instead of searching and comparing websites, which can result in unreliable information and reduced exposure for companies.

Purpose and Problem to Solve

In August 2026, AI-driven traffic in retail grew 127% YoY and is expected to remain strong and increase to 130% during the holidays (Adobe). When a shopper asks AI for the best laptop under \$500, they often make a decision without ever visiting a company's website. If a company isn't mentioned, or its product is described incorrectly (wrong price or features), the customer may never reach its website. Companies lose visibility and traffic they can't measure, and customers risk buying based on unreliable information.

NARAH aims to close that gap. Shoppers connect NARAH to their AI assistant of choice, the same way students connect Canvas. When they ask about a product, their AI pulls verified information from official and authorized company/retailer sites. Companies subscribe (tier model provided in the Business section) to keep their product information complete and accurate, and use the NARAH dashboard to monitor how they appear in AI answers and where to improve. The NARAH dashboard will provide relevant information to the company using product feeds, web crawlers and APIs. Once a company makes adjustments, AI can provide customers with information that is more accurate and up to date.

Goals and Objectives

- Raise a client's inclusion rate in AI shopping answers by 5 percentage points within 90 days
- Keep 95% or more of tracked product facts stated correctly across AI assistants
- Reduce returns and support tickets tied to AI misinformation by 10% during the pilot, measured before and after
- Grow each client's AI-referred traffic and conversions, tracked in dashboard reports
- Reach 50,000 shoppers using the NARAH connector in the first year

Key Assumptions and Sources

- **Development costs:** based on the U.S. median software developer wage of \$135,980 (BLS, May 2025), about \$11,300 per month; five months of development rounded to \$60,000, part-time maintenance at half that rate. Source: <https://www.bls.gov/ooh/computer-and-information-technology/software-developers.htm>
- **Pricing benchmarks:** AI visibility tools range from \$29 to \$489 per month for self-serve plans, with enterprise plans from \$1,000 (Otterly.AI, 2026) up to \$2,000 to \$5,000+ per month (Maintouch, 2026). Sources: <https://otterly.ai/pricing> and <https://maintouch.com/blogs/profound-ai-pricing>
- **AI API usage:** 10 clients $\times$ 200 questions $\times$ 4 AI assistants $\times$ 30 days = 240,000 queries per month at about \$0.005 each (team estimate). Pricing reference: <https://openai.com/api/pricing>
- **Cloud hosting and insurance:** team estimates, to be confirmed with the AWS Pricing Calculator and insurance quotes. Reference: <https://calculator.aws>
- **Business formation:** Texas LLC Certificate of Formation filing fee of \$300 (Texas Secretary of State). Source: <https://www.sos.state.tx.us/corp/instructions/205.shtml>
- **Funding source:** Alamo Angels, Texas' largest network of accredited investors. Source: <https://alamoangels.com>
- **Revenue:** \$969 average per client per month $\times$ 12 months $\times$ average clients during each year (5, 25 and 70).